5.3. Class variables and properties

So far all of the properties you've defined with classes belong to instances of classes. This means they're properties found on instances of the class:

```
class Product
  render: ->

instanceOfProduct = new Product
instanceOfProduct.render
```

render method defined on class

render method invoked as property of an instance of the Product class

Some properties don't make sense as instances of the class. Some properties make more sense as properties of the class itself. Imagine all of the products sold in Agtron's shop are faulty and need to be recalled. It's easy to invoke `recall` on the `Product` class:

```
Product.recall()
```

It's not so easy to hunt down all of the products ever constructed and invoke `recall` on each one. You might argue that it more accurately reflects the real world for things like product recalls to be much more complicated, but you like simplicity. Class properties can be a simple and useful technique.

These are Class Methods, Right?

Class properties in CoffeeScript can serve similar purposes to class methods in Ruby, Smalltalk, or Objective-C and even static methods in Java or C++.

5.3.1. Usage

Imagine now that Agtron wants a product search feature on his website so that people can find products by name. When a user searches for shark repellant, they should be shown a list of all shark repellant products that Agtron has for sale. The search feature will have an input field where users can enter a search term. Agtron's design for the new homepage is shown in figure 5.3.